

USER MANUAL

BRASS QUARTET BY SPITFIRE AUDIO

SPITFIRE AUDIO

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OVERVIEW

Created exclusively for Ableton Live II, Brass Quartet by Spitfire Audio contains all new sample content recorded in the intimate acoustic of Air Edel Studios, London. The pack features a range of playing styles from essential articulations to experimental techniques. Each expertly sampled note has been captured in detail using vintage valve and ribbon microphones, blended together to form a versatile, bespoke mix.

Spitfire Audio selected four of London's finest brass players to form a quartet consisting of Trombone, Tenor Horn (aka French Horn), Flugelhorn and Trumpet. The players were recorded together as a pre-orchestrated ensemble that seamlessly blends from one instrument to the next, resulting in instantly playable instruments.

The pack contains 19 multi-sampled instrument presets, including 9 MPE presets that provide an exciting and intuitive way to create expressive performances. 3 bespoke Max for Live devices have been created to expand the features of Ableton's Sampler for added realism and 50 MIDI clips provide a starting point for experimentation and inspiration.

Brass Quartet by Spitfire Audio is included in Live II Suite. Live II Intro and Standard users can purchase the pack in the [Ableton Packs shop](#).

QUICK SPECS

19 Instrument Presets
50 MIDI Clips
3 Max for Live Devices
1 Bespoke Mix

~0.3GB Download size
~0.7GB Install size

INSTRUMENTS

These multi-sampled instruments feature 8 Macro controls allowing you to control the ambience, define the tone and sculpt the performances of the musicians to create realistic and expressive compositions. The instruments are grouped into three folders:

- All-in-one
- Individual
- MPE

ALL-IN-ONE INSTRUMENTS

This pack contains two “All-in-one” instrument presets which contain multiple playing styles or “techniques”. The techniques can be seamlessly blended between using the Technique macro or immediately switched between using the Macro Variations.

Long All-in-one — This instrument is best suited to playing longer sustained notes and melodic lines. It contains the following techniques:

- Long Air
- Long Hollow
- Long Senza Vibrato
- Long Vibrato
- Long Pitch Bend
- Long Flutter

Short All-in-one — This instrument is best suited for playing short abrupt phrases and runs as well as ostinatos. It contains the following techniques:

- Short Soft
- Short Staccato
- Short Staccatissimo

The Technique control was inspired by subtractive synths. Synths of this nature allow the timbre of the sound to be changed using the filter cut-off control, producing a mellow timbre when the cut-off is low and a brighter sound when the cut-off is increased. Instead of using filters, the All-in-one instruments’ Technique control changes the timbre by crossfading between different layers of samples.

When the Technique control is low, a soft and gentle technique can be heard; as the control is increased, the layers of samples change and the timbre becomes brighter, harder and more intense. This is made possible by Max for Live devices inside the instrument rack that modulate the volume of each sample layer.

For a list of all controls and how they can be used, please refer to the Macro Controls section. A full list of techniques and how they are performed can be found in the Techniques section.

INDIVIDUAL INSTRUMENTS

The “Individual” instruments use the same samples as the “All-in-one” instruments, but rather than having multiple playing styles together each technique is in a separate instrument preset. These presets allow you to load different techniques on separate tracks, giving more control over processing and effects. They can also be helpful if CPU usage is a concern, as the individual instruments have fewer layers of samples and as a result fewer instances of Sampler.

MPE INSTRUMENTS

This pack contains 9 MPE instrument presets that provide an expressive and intuitive way to interact with sampled instruments. The presets are split into three curated combinations of techniques, each with three different ways to control the instruments. The three combinations and techniques each one contains are listed below.

MPE Erosion

- Air
- Senza Vibrato
- Pitch Bend & Flutter (Combined)

MPE Intimate

- Air
- Hollow
- Senza Vibrato

MPE Vibrato

- Hollow
- Senza Vibrato
- Vibrato

Like the All-in-one presets, the MPE instrument presets allow you to smoothly change between techniques. Rather than being mapped to a Macro control, the MPE presets change the technique based on the position of your fingers on the MPE controller. This change in technique is independent for each finger and as a result, each note that you play can have a different technique and can transition between techniques without affecting other notes that are being played.

(Pressure) presets – these instruments change the technique in reaction to the pressure each note is held at. As you change from pressing softly to pressing hard on the controller, the sound of the instrument changes from a soft and gentle technique to a harder, brighter sound.

(Slide) presets – these instruments change the technique in reaction to the vertical position each note is held at. As you slide from the bottom of the key to the top of the key, the sound of the instrument changes from a soft and gentle technique to a harder, brighter sound.

(Slide & Pressure) presets – as with the (*Pressure*) presets, these instruments change the technique in reaction to pressure. Slide is used to control the level that is sent to a long reverb, allowing you to slide up the keys and change the ambience of the instrument from dry and intimate to cavernous and dark.

These presets have Pressure Invert and/or Slide Invert macros that allow you to reverse how MPE varies the technique. As an example with Pressure inverted, when you press softly on the controller the instrument will produce a hard sound, and vice versa. Alongside controlling polyphonic technique, the pitch bend of each note can be changed independently.

For a list of all controls and how they can be used, please refer to the Macro Controls section. A full list of techniques and how they are performed can be found in the Techniques section.

MACRO CONTROLS

Dynamics – controls the dynamic that the players are performing. By varying this control, expressive and realistic progressions can be created. It can be helpful to MIDI map this Macro to a MIDI controller to allow you to shape the dynamics of the phrases as you play.

Velocity Sens. – controls the velocity sensitivity of the instrument. At low values, the instrument reacts less to the velocity that is being played.

Technique – controls the timbre and playing style by crossfading between different layers of samples. It can be helpful to MIDI map this Macro to a MIDI controller to allow you to shape the tone and articulation of phrases as you play.

Saturation – controls the gain of Live's Saturation audio effect. At low values this can add colour and warmth to the instruments. As the Saturation is increased, the effect becomes more intense and experimental.

Reverb Level – controls the send level to Live's Hybrid Reverb. For these instruments, we have created a realistic and intimate hall-style preset.

Reverb Time – controls the decay time of Live's Hybrid Reverb.

Attack – controls the attack time of Sampler's ADSR envelope. This can be used to soften the start of the samples.

Release – controls the release and decay time of Sampler's ADSR envelope. This can be used to reduce the natural ambience captured in the samples.

Release Level – controls the volume of the release triggers. Release triggers are recordings of the end of each note, and are triggered when the note is released. These samples add realism to the instruments by capturing the sound of the players ending the note and the ambience of the room as the sound fades away.

Tone – controls the colour and character of the instrument by modulating an EQ preset created specifically for the Brass Quartet.

Volume – controls the output volume of the instrument.

TECHNIQUES

Long Air – For this experimental and challenging playing style, the players were asked to play very softly whilst producing as little note as humanly possible. The result is a very delicate sound and a large proportion is the ‘hiss’ of the air passing through the instrument.

Long Hollow – a gentle and round playing style with as few overtones as possible.

Long Senza Vibrato – A standard sustained note, performed without any vibrato.

Long Vibrato – A standard sustained note, performed with a moderate amount of vibrato.

Long Flutter – The player rolls a silent ‘R’ with the mouth whilst playing, giving a unique airflow that creates a very characteristic sound.

Long Pitch Bend – For this technique, the players held a sustained note and then randomly began to bend the notes down in pitch ever so slightly. This results in quite an eerie, textural sound, reminiscent of the doppler effect.

Short Soft – A softer sounding short note. Typically brass players would articulate short notes with their tongue to create an abrupt start, but for this technique, the players were instructed to play the note without tonguing the start.

Short Staccato – Staccato in notation refers to a ‘shortened and detached’ style of playing. In the case of samples, this usually refers to a single, defined short note.

Short Staccatissimo – A very short and sharp note, even shorter than a Staccato.

MIDI CLIPS

50 Live MIDI clips are included in this pack. These can provide inspiration or a starting point for experimentation. Some clips contain short, abrupt MIDI notes and as a result are best used with a “Short” technique. Others clips contain longer sustain notes and suit “Long” techniques best. When the clip is dragged onto a blank MIDI track, it will load up with either a “Short” or “Long” instrument preset depending on what will sound best.

MAX FOR LIVE DEVICES

The instruments in this pack use three Max for Live devices to allow different layers of samples to be heard, depending on what is played and the position of the Macro controls. These additional layers of samples add realism and depth to the instruments.

These Max for Live devices have not been designed to be interacted with directly by the user. Instead, they are either pre-mapped to the Macro controls or react to the MIDI that they receive, and can be found hidden away inside the instrument racks. Each device and its purpose is listed below.

MPE Note Off – This device is used inside the MPE instrument presets. It stores the most recent pressure, slide and polyphonic pitch bend values for each note played, and waits until the note is released. When the device receives a note-off message, it sends out the most recent pressure, slide and pitch bend along with a note-on message to trigger the release sample.

Mod Table – This device is used to independently control the chain volumes of different sample layers within the instrument racks. The input has been pre-mapped to either the Dynamics or Technique macros. As the input control is changed, its value is translated via intricately programmed, non-linear curves that are preset within each device. The output is then pre-mapped to the sample layer’s chain volume. This allows some samples to be faded in and then back out over the course of a specific part of the input control’s range. This is fundamental in creating the seamless crossfades between playing styles that are employed in the “All-in-one” instruments.

Group Start – This device will allow the MIDI received at its input to pass through to the output if the “Control” is between two preset values. This device is used on release trigger groups to prevent any samples being triggered if the chain volume of the sample layer is at -inf dB, helping to keep the voice count and CPU usage to a minimum.

APPENDIX A — FAQS AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Q: DO THE SPITFIRE AUDIO PACKS WORK IN LIVE 10 SUITE?

The packs are made exclusively for Live 11 Suite and aren't backwards compatible with older versions of Ableton.

Q: CAN THESE PACKS BE USED WITH A DAW THAT ISN'T ABLETON LIVE 11?

These packs are exclusively for use in Ableton Live 11.

Q: DO THEY USE ANY PRE-EXISTING CONTENT FROM SPITFIRE AUDIO?

These packs contain new content created exclusively for Ableton Live 11.

Q: HOW DO I DOWNLOAD THE PACKS?

They are available for download on Ableton's pack page [HERE](#).

Q: WHO DO I GET IN CONTACT WITH IF I HAVE MORE QUESTIONS?

Please contact [ABLETON SUPPORT](#).